

2.5.	Form and time limit of appeal	1306
2.5.1	Electronic filing of appeal	1306
2.5.2	Form and content of notice of appeal (Rule 99(1) EPC)	1307
a)	Rule 99(1)(a) EPC	1308
b)	Rule 99(1)(b) EPC	1311
c)	Rule 99(1)(c) EPC	1312
d)	Rule 99(3) EPC	1314
2.5.3	Appeal filed within the time limit	1314
a)	Notification issues	1314
b)	Languages	1315
c)	Misleading decisions of the department of first instance	1315
2.5.4	Payment of appeal fee	1316
a)	Notice of appeal not filed	1316
b)	Payment of only one appeal fee	1316
c)	Reduced fee for appeal filed by a natural person or an entity	1317
2.5.5	Appeal deemed not to have been filed	1320
2.6.	Statement of grounds of appeal	1320
2.6.1	Legal provisions	1320
2.6.2	Form of statement of grounds of appeal	1321
2.6.3	Content of the statement of grounds of appeal	1321
a)	General	1321
b)	Direct link between the contested decision and the statement of grounds of appeal	1322
c)	Adequate reasoning for an appeal against a refusal of the application	1323
d)	Adequate reasoning in an appeal filed by the opponent	1324
e)	Statement of the legal or factual reasons	1325
f)	Addressing the reasons given in the decision in the statement of grounds of appeal	1326
g)	Complete case within the meaning of Art. 12(3) RPBA 2020	1327
h)	Mere repetition of arguments	1327
i)	Objection not raised at first instance	1327
j)	Statement of grounds of appeal not filed in full	1328
k)	Duty of board to be impartial	1328
2.6.4	New case raised	1329
a)	Appeal based on the same ground for opposition	1329
b)	Taking new submissions into consideration	1330
c)	Amended claims filed	1330
2.6.5	References to earlier submissions	1332
2.6.6	Arguments need not be new or relevant	1333
2.6.7	Exceptional circumstances warranting admissibility of appeal	1334
a)	Immediately apparent the contested decision cannot be supported	1334
b)	Patent proprietor requests revocation	1334
c)	Substantial procedural violation	1334
2.6.8	No partial admissibility of appeal	1334
2.7.	Examination of the admissibility of appeal in every phase of appeal proceedings	1335

2.8.	Cases where admissibility of appeal need not be considered	1335
2.9.	Interlocutory revision	1336
2.9.1	General	1336
2.9.2	The department of first instance's obligation to rectify the decision	1337
2.9.3	Well-founded appeal within the meaning of Art. 109(1) EPC	1337
2.9.4	Competence of the department of first instance	1338
2.9.5	"Cassatory" or "reformatory" interlocutory revision	1338
3.	Substantive examination of the appeal	1339
3.1.	Binding effect of requests – no reformatio in peius	1339
3.1.1	Reformatio in peius does not apply separately to each point	1339
3.1.2	Reformatio in peius and devolutive effect of appeal	1340
3.1.3	Cases where reformatio in peius does not apply	1340
3.1.4	Patentee as sole appellant	1340
3.1.5	Opponent as sole appellant	1341
3.1.6	Revocation of patent	1342
3.1.7	Exceptions to the prohibition of reformatio in peius	1343
a)	Limited exceptions to the prohibition of reformatio in peius – G 1/99	1343
b)	Case law around G 1/99	1343
c)	Remittal to the department of first instance	1345
d)	Lack of clarity	1345
e)	Causal link	1346
f)	Undisclosed disclaimer	1346
3.1.8	Reformatio in peius and lack of cross-appeal in the EPC	1346
3.2.	Subject-matter under examination	1347
3.2.1	Primary object of the appeal proceedings – Article 12(2) RPBA 2020	1347
3.2.2	Complete case on appeal	1347
3.2.3	Opposition appeal proceedings	1349
a)	Admissibility of opposition	1349
b)	The notice of appeal	1349
c)	Unopposed subject-matter not reviewed	1349
d)	Dependent claims	1350
e)	Appeal by patentee against revocation	1350
f)	Removal of references in dependent claims	1351
g)	Abandonment of subject-matter	1351
h)	Fresh ground for opposition on appeal	1352
i)	No general review of the first-instance decision	1354
j)	Ambiguities in the claims	1354
k)	Ex officio examination of Art. 123(2) EPC	1354
3.2.4	Patentability requirements under examination in ex parte proceedings	1355
3.3.	Facts under examination – applying Article 114 EPC in appeal proceedings	1356
3.3.1	Boards to examine facts of own motion	1356
3.4.	Review of first-instance discretionary decisions	1357
3.4.1	Principles applying to the review of first-instance discretionary decisions	1357
a)	General	1357
b)	Proper exercise of discretion	1358
c)	Review of first-instance discretionary decisions taken on substantive grounds	1358

3.4.2	Development of the case law on reviewing first-instance discretionary decisions	1359
a)	Early case law on exercising discretion	1359
b)	Case law on exercise of discretion under Art. 12(4) RPBA 2007	1360
3.4.3	The boards' own discretion	1360
a)	Submissions refused at first instance admitted on appeal	1360
b)	Submissions not admitted by the boards	1362
c)	Discretion misused by the department of first instance	1363
3.4.4	Submissions admitted at first instance are part of the appeal proceedings	1363
3.4.5	Review of an opposition division's discretionary decision (not) to admit a new ground for opposition	1366
3.4.6	Review of discretion – stay of proceedings	1367
4.	New submissions on appeal – case law on the RPBA 2020	1368
4.1.	Introduction	1368
4.1.1	Legal basis	1368
a)	Legal bases in the EPC	1368
b)	Legal bases in the Rules of Procedure of the Boards of Appeal	1369
4.1.2	Primary object of appeal proceedings and the "convergent approach" to amendments made to party's case	1370
4.2.	Amendment to a party's case	1372
4.2.1	First level of the convergent approach: amendments to a party's case within the meaning of Article 12(4) RPBA 2020	1373
a)	Principles	1373
b)	Submissions on appeal not directed to requests, facts, objections, arguments or evidence on which the decision under appeal was based	1373
c)	Not admissibly raised and maintained at first instance	1374
4.2.2	Second and third levels of the convergent approach: amendments to an appeal case within the meaning of Article 13(1) and (2) RPBA 2020	1374
a)	Principles	1374
b)	Submissions at first instance not automatically part of appeal case	1376
c)	Request for dismissal of the appeal and maintenance of the patent	1377
d)	Deletion of claims or alternatives within claims	1377
e)	New request combining subject-matter of previously filed claims	1380
f)	Request paraphrased and not set out in full	1380
g)	Request considered in decision under appeal and clearly specified in grounds of appeal	1381
h)	Resubmission of withdrawn requests	1381
i)	Requests belatedly substantiated	1381
j)	Requests reordered	1382
k)	Fleshing out objections not adequately substantiated in the grounds of appeal or reply	1382
l)	New objection based on documents already on file – new arguments with factual elements	1383
m)	Further developing arguments within the framework of the appeal case as submitted so far	1384
n)	Submissions concerning interpretation of the law	1385

o)	Information supporting oral submissions	1386
p)	Translation filed later	1386
q)	Late assertion of a breach of the right to be heard	1387
4.3.	First level of the convergent approach – submissions in the grounds of appeal and the reply – Article 12(3) to (6) RPBA 2020	1387
4.3.1	Principles	1387
4.3.2	Transitional provisions	1388
a)	Applicability of Article 12(4) to (6) RPBA 2020	1388
b)	Applicability of Article 12(3) RPBA 2020	1388
4.3.3	Amendment within the meaning of Article 12(4) RPBA 2020	1389
4.3.4	Discretion under Article 12(4) RPBA 2020	1389
a)	Requirement that amendment be identified and reasoned and that timing of its filing be reasoned – Article 12(4), third and fourth sentences, RPBA 2020	1389
b)	Complexity of amendment	1389
c)	Suitability to address issues leading to decision under appeal	1390
d)	Additional issues raised – procedural economy	1390
e)	Convergence criterion	1391
f)	No objection raised by opposing party	1391
4.3.5	Incomplete case in grounds of appeal or reply – Article 12(3) RPBA 2020 in conjunction with Article 12(5) RPBA 2020	1391
a)	Principles	1391
b)	Incomplete appeal case – Article 12(3) RPBA 2020	1392
c)	Discretion under Art. 12(5) RPBA 2020	1393
4.3.6	Submissions not admitted at first instance – Article 12(6), first sentence, RPBA 2020	1394
4.3.7	Submissions that should have been submitted at first instance – Article 12(6), second sentence, RPBA 2020	1394
4.4.	Second level of the convergent approach – submissions made after filing of grounds of appeal or reply – Article 13(1) RPBA 2020	1396
4.4.1	Principles	1396
4.4.2	Transitional provisions – immediate applicability of Article 13(1) RPBA 2020	1396
4.4.3	Amendment to appeal case within the meaning of Article 13(1) RPBA 2020	1397
4.4.4	Party's duty to justify amendment	1397
a)	Principles	1397
b)	Party's duty to provide reasons for not submitting amendment at an earlier stage	1397
c)	Substantiation of amendments to patent application or patent	1398
4.4.5	Discretion under Article 13(1) RPBA 2020 – new requests	1399
a)	Deletion of claims or alternatives within claims	1399
b)	Timely and legitimate reaction to issues raised – requests admitted	1400
c)	New request in response to preliminary opinion of the board clarifying objections – admitted	1401
d)	Board's communication confirming the opposition division's or opponent's opinion – not a justification	1402

e)	Issues underlying board's conclusions already raised in the decision under appeal – request not admitted	1403
f)	Request does not prima facie overcome objection – procedural economy – not admitted	1403
g)	Claim amendments prima facie give rise to new objections – requests not admitted	1404
h)	Inclusion of possibly unsearched features – procedural economy – request not admitted	1404
i)	Claim requests becoming non-convergent by later submission of further requests – not admitted	1404
j)	Filing of reply to the appeal shortly after expiry of non-extended period – admitted	1405
4.4.6	Discretion under Article 13(1) RPBA 2020 – new facts, objections, arguments and evidence	1405
a)	New documents filed in response to experimental data submitted by the patent proprietor – admitted	1405
b)	No new complexity introduced – objection admitted	1406
c)	New lines of attack based on documents submitted during first-instance proceedings – not admitted	1406
d)	Relevance of new lines of attack for assessment of patentability – not a sufficient justification	1407
e)	New documents not prima facie relevant – not admitted	1407
f)	Late substantiation of lines of attack – additional complexity – procedural economy – submissions not admitted	1408
g)	Late-filed evidence of a public prior use – not admitted	1408
h)	Communication in preparation for the oral proceedings not an invitation to file further submissions on known objections	1409
i)	Objections not a reaction to unexpected developments in the appeal proceedings – not admitted	1409
j)	New document originating from the patent proprietor submitted by the appellant-opponent – not admitted	1410
4.5.	Third level of the convergence approach – submissions filed after notification of summons or after expiry of period specified in Rule 100(2) EPC communication – Article 13(2) RPBA 2020	1411
4.5.1	Principles	1411
4.5.2	Transitional provisions	1413
a)	Application of Article 13(1) RPBA 2020 and/or Article 13 RPBA 2007 in transitional cases	1413
b)	No contradiction between Article 13(1) RPBA 2020 and Article 13 RPBA 2007 or the EPC	1414
c)	Applicability of Article 13(2) RPBA 2020 in cases of postponement of oral proceedings	1414
d)	Applicability of Article 13(2) RPBA 2020 in cases where the statement of grounds of appeal or the reply was filed before the entry into force of the RPBA 2020	1414
4.5.3	Amendment to an appeal case within the meaning of Article 13(2) RPBA 2020	1415